

Fisheries and Oceans Canada's Fish and Fish Habitat Protection Program Engagement Fact Sheet

January 2021

Engagement Framework

KEYWORDS

- Engagement
- Engagement continuum
- Sharing
- Working together
- Entrusting

PURPOSE

By Fall 2021, DFO's Fish and Fish Habitat Protection Program will adopt an Engagement Framework to support better decision making through consistent and predictable engagement with partners and stakeholders. This will better inform the development of regulations, policies, guidance, and processes.

MANDATE

- Government of Canada commitment to Open Government and Engagement
- Fisheries and Oceans Canada (DFO) has a mandate commitment to govern with openness, effectiveness and transparency
- Modernization of the Fish and Fish Habitat Protection Program (FFHPP) includes a new engagement function

The department will use complementary strategies and approaches, in addition to those outlined in the Engagement Framework, to guide its engagement activities with Indigenous peoples

DESCRIPTION

To modernize the Fish and Fish Habitat Protection Program, we want to engage in a way that is meaningful, consistent, and predictable with relevant parties interested in our activities. This can include with, among others, Indigenous peoples, governments and regulators, the regulated community, and conservation groups.

This collective engagement will contribute to strong, inclusive and impactful policies, regulations, guidance and associated actions, that will in turn, conserve and protect fish and fish habitat for future generations.

We are drafting an Engagement Framework that builds upon existing engagement approaches, the International Association of Public Participation foundations and the Government of Canada Engagement Principles and Practices.

KEY CONCEPTS

Engagement will be designed and implemented according to the complexity, importance, and timeline of the topic. Based on these elements, each topic will fit into one of three engagement "intensities" (sharing, working together, entrusting) along an engagement "continuum" (Figure 2).

- Each intensity will have:
 - Predictable points of engagement throughout the product development cycle (Figure 1)
 - Standardized yet customizable combinations of engagement tools
- Incorporates standard feedback or follow-up

This is a fundamental shift from a traditional reactive engagement approach to a modern and open one

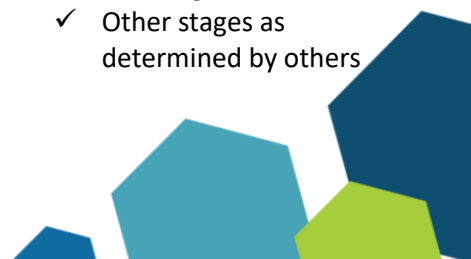


Figure 1. Product Development Cycle



ENGAGEMENT CONTINUUM KEY CONCEPTS

Engagement Continuum	Sharing  <i>When government is uniquely accountable</i>	Working Together  <i>When there may be interrelated accountabilities</i>	Entrusting  <i>When parties have their own accountabilities</i>
Goal	- Share information and perspectives in a timely manner - Actively listen on issues that matter to others, - Strive for a mutual understanding of key issues and messages	- Gather feedback and input throughout the process - Understand and consider perspectives - Identify opportunities to collaborate	To enable and empower others to develop, shape and implement specific aspects of initiatives that support our collective priorities and achieve our shared goals
Objectives	- Build trust, - Create awareness, and/or - Educate	- Gather feedback - Seek input, and/or - Collaborate	Entrust (others to take on activities aligned with departmental objectives)
Commitments	- Listen to issues that matter to you. - Keep you informed about our initiatives while striving for a mutual understanding.	- Provide opportunities for input and to discuss or collaborate on aspects of our initiatives. - Provide feedback on how input influences our decisions.	Provide opportunities, structure and /or support for others to lead on aspects of initiatives that support collective priorities.
Examples of Tools	- Fact sheets - Surveys - Webinars - Website	- Fact sheets or discussion papers - Surveys and smart forms - Webinars and open houses - Collaborative online platform - Interactive workshops - Breakout groups	- Formal agreements - Support for initiatives led by others
Points of engagement in the product development cycle	3 Points of Engagement at: ✓ Planning ✓ Reviewing ✓ Implementing	4 points of engagement at: ✓ Planning ✓ Shaping ✓ Reviewing ✓ Implementing	At least 1 point of engagement at: ✓ Planning ✓ Other stages as determined by others



ENGAGEMENT APPROACH FOR THE ENGAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

Fisheries and Oceans Canada has a mandate commitment to govern with openness, effectiveness and transparency.

There are a number of ways that you can get involved, better understand the DFO products under development, and share your insights and comments with us. Below is an overview of the engagement status, the engagement continuum intensity, as well as some of the documents and activities, when they are available, and where to find them for this phase of engagement for the Engagement Framework.



Figure 2. Status within the Product Development cycle

KEY TOPICS THAT WE WOULD LIKE TO SEEK YOUR INPUT ON

1. What key concepts of the Engagement Framework (e.g. continuum, associated points of engagement, engagement tools and approaches) are working well?
 - What revisions can be made to improve the Framework's clarity, effectiveness or efficiency?
2. Which engagement tools are working well?
 - What revisions could be made to improve the activities' effectiveness, timeliness, relevance or responsiveness?

HOW TO GET INVOLVED

We will look for input on the Engagement Framework concepts alongside all engagement on specific program products

Proposed Engagement Activities		Approximate Timing
Background Information	• Fact Sheet	Available
	• Webinar or recorded presentation	Available
Engagement Approach	• Submit comments on engagement approach	December – June 2021
	• Engagement for Key Partners and Stakeholders	January – August 2021
	• Regional Sessions (as needed)	January – August 2021
	• Engagement Summary	September 2021

Visit www.talkfishhabitat.ca for more resources and to share your thoughts.



Please direct any questions or concerns to FFHPP at
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